

The B3



A look at all the hype and talk behind the biggest games at E3

The Electronic Entertainment Expo (E3) is where you get to witness the latest groundbreaking technologies for computers and video game consoles. Held at Los Angeles, the eighth E3 drew in a crowd of 60,000 game industry professionals—

from the most influential, to the most diehard fan boys. Last year, the trinity of the Xbox, the GameCube, and the PlayStation 2 outnumbered the PC stalls. However this year, PC games shone bright with innovations in technology and design.

America's Army: Operations

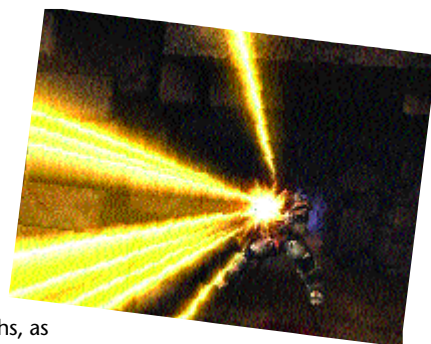
America's Army: Operations looks like yet another realism based, online, teamplay, and first-person shooter like *Ghost Recon* or *Counter-Strike*. Except for two things: the US Army is developing it and it's going to be completely free! Created with the latest *Unreal Warfare* technology, the game will try to recreate the Army experience. It allows up to three players and will contain about 20 levels set in various locations around the world in its initial release. The US Army is planning on releasing the game free of cost later this year, via the Internet and magazine cover-mount CDs.



Unreal Games

Long, long time ago, way back in 1999, *Unreal Tournament* revolutionised the FPS genre with solid graphics, networking, and multiple game-play modes.

The year 2002 will be a crucial one for Epic games, with the anticipated release of *Unreal II*, the single player sequel to the original *Unreal* game. *Unreal II* is being developed by Legend Entertainment and is scheduled for release towards the second half of the year. *Unreal Tournament 2003*, the sequel to *Unreal Tournament*, is in the making by Digital Extremes and will be available in the next couple of months, as will *Unreal Championship*, an upcoming action game set in the Unreal universe for the Xbox game console.



The Sims Online will let you do all the crazy stuff you've been doing with *The Sims*—online, with just about anybody in the world. A fully online version of the all-time best-selling computer game should open up some intriguing scenarios. It has all the standard features of the original game such as charisma building, cementing positive or negative relationships with other Sims, along with new features such as instant messaging.



Maxis is also poised to release a progression of the *SimCity* series this year, *SimCity 4*. The sequel's improved God mode will let you control the natural disasters such as fires, erupting volcanoes and whirlwinds that hit your city.